Connecting with the gamers: The proof that the product was of immense quality was when Microsoft decided to use the NVIDIA GPU for its first Xbox launch. The Sony PS3 followed in 2005. This meant that all the game creators were using the NVIDIA gaming platform. Apart from that, all recent Hollywood movies with great graphics and animation that were nominated for or awarded the Oscar, were created on machines with NVIDIA GPUs.

So, being the brand of choice for Xbox and PlayStation, as well as the brand that helped deliver Oscar winning movies, ensured NVIDIA became synonymous with gaming. Gamers saw the proof of this every day as they enjoyed the latest graphics on their Xbox or PlayStation.

But NVIDIA was not happy just providing the proof of its capabilities to its consumers. It needed to connect with them too; so it used social media in a big way. The company has a popular blog, on which employees write about all the latest happenings at NVIDIA and this content is shared on all the social media platforms. YouTube not only showcases the latest product offerings, but also features user-generated content, in the form of reviews by tech influencers or even gaming simulations. In fact, other tech companies are no different – they all have a strong network of tech influencers that they keep happy in order to ensure positive reviews for their products.

Another key effort by NVIDIA to connect with gamers was to organise gaming conferences. The big one in the USA is the Games Developers Conference (GDC), and in Europe, it is Gamescom that happens in Germany. NVIDIA puts up a great show at these conferences, unveiling new launches and technologies.

GPGPUs are the future: A recent development that has made things interesting is that GPUs can now be used for some general-purpose computing so we have what is also called GPGPU. Because the GPU can do so many more parallel functions, it has the potential to replace the CPU some day. And that is not something Intel is going to allow so easily.

NVIDIA's Gamescom in Germany

Volkswagen's I.D. Buzz powered by NVIDIA DRIVE IX technology

In fact, there have been some legal battles that Intel has fought with NVIDIA, AMD and the Federal Trade Commission (FTC). The FTC is a US government body that protects the consumer and aims to prevent anti-competitive activities by companies. Intel has not won these battles, and has had to settle and pay.

So, when a GPU can perform some of the functions of a CPU because it has much more processing power, some interesting uses for it have emerged in the industry. This is one of the key reasons that the AI revolution has gone into overdrive and has also led to the creation of supercomputers, with tremendous processing power. GPUs are basically a supercomputer processor.

The smart city is another use case. Cameras placed all over the city capture a lot of data, GPUs analyse it and help when it comes to aspects related to traffic and parking management, law enforcement and city services. For healthcare, GPUs can provide the computing power for tasks as diverse as medical imaging to analysing genomes.

NVIDIA recognises that we are living in a 'breakthrough phase'. Academicians are pioneering scientific discoveries and they need computing power for their experiments and discoveries. Hence, NVIDIA is convincing universities to adopt its computing power.

Retail is using AI to optimise the supply chain, to study user data to increase customer conversion, to provide customised shopping experiences, and for micro-targeting customers with relation to pricing and other areas.